

The new *Repertoire* exam format

From this year, AMEB are now offering a new **exam format alternative** across the board that allows candidates to simply present a program of works.

The Trial Recital Exam is no longer examinable. Instead, a ***Repertoire*** exam option will now be examinable alongside the traditional exam format (referred to from 2019 as the ***Comprehensive*** exam).

A ***Repertoire*** exam option is available from 2019 onward for **all** instruments and subjects, with the following exceptions:

- Piano for Leisure
- Singing for Leisure
- Saxophone for Leisure
- CPM subjects
- Accordion
- Some Speech and Drama syllabuses

The following table compares the content of each exam type for Level 1 and for Level 2. In a ***Repertoire*** exam, no Technical Work, no Aural Tests, Sight Reading or General Knowledge are examined. Think of it as a ***Repertoire-ONLY*** exam.

	Level 1			Level 2		
	Comprehensive	Repertoire	For Leisure	Comprehensive	Repertoire	For Leisure
Technical work	Yes	No	Some	Yes	No	Some
Pieces	3 - 5	4	3	4 – 6	5	3
Aural tests	Yes	No	Either/or	Yes	No	Either/or
Sight reading	Yes	No	Either/or	Yes	No	Either/or
General Knowledge	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Additional requirement	No	No	No	Yes, G6 and above	Yes, G6 and above	No

Level 1 format (Preliminary to Grade 4)

- List A*
- List B*
- List C*
- Additional item of Own Choice

* List items must be chosen from lists published in the **2019** (newest) Syllabus

Four pieces in total are presented and each piece has equal weighting toward grade.

Level 1 candidates present one List A, one List B and one List C. These **MUST** come from the **MOST RECENT syllabus** for that instrument. This is an important point for Piano candidates to note given that there is a brand new Piano syllabus (2019) this year.

Level 2 format (Grades 5 - 8)

Level 2 candidates prepare five works (3 List works from 2019 Syllabus + 2 Own choice works).

Candidates must select one work from **three different** lists (List A, B, C and/or D) in the full syllabus for that grade. For example, one work from each of:

- Lists A, B and C, *or*
- A, C and D, *or*
- A, B and D *or*
- B, C and D

In addition to these, candidates will present two Own Choice works for a total program of five works.

Is this an easier exam to pass than the Comprehensive exam?

The new format does not imply a way to cut corners in order to 'fast track' musical advancement. Sound musical technique and understanding may not be examined in a **Repertoire** exam, but it still must be **inherent** in the performance of their program of works. Examiners will still ensure comments and gradings are provided according to the syllabus requirements and grading descriptors in the 2019 AMEB Manual of Syllabuses. Aspects of technique or musicality found lacking will be commented upon and reflected in the grade awarded.

How do I make an Own Choice selection?

Own Choice pieces can include any work not listed on the syllabus, but which is of a similar length and educational value to the other pieces on the syllabus lists for that particular grade. It is the responsibility of the candidate and their teacher to ensure that the Own Choice work selected is appropriate for the grade. Please note that **AMEB is unable to provide prior approval** for Own Choice works.

The easiest option would be to **double up a list piece** from that grade and syllabus as the Own Choice item, or perhaps select an item from a parallel syllabus. For example, a Saxophone candidate might select an own choice from the same grade in the Saxophone for Leisure syllabus.

Repertoire candidates will still receive a full page report, just as the **Comprehensive** candidate does.

Is Own Choice the same as Extra List?

Own Choice is NOT the same as the *Extra list*. In a **Comprehensive** exam, *Extra list* items only form a **small subset of Section III**. Performance of the *Extra list* is a small consideration toward the final grading. In **Repertoire** exams, each **Own choice item** counts toward 20% (Level 1) or 25% (Level 2) of the final grade awarded. *If the Own choice item does not appear in the current syllabus lists, students are advised to bring a copy of the music into the exam room for the examiner to reference.*

Does an Own Choice work have to be accompanied?

Yes, any *Own Choice* work printed with an accompaniment part must be performed accompanied.

Can I change my enrolment from Comprehensive to Repertoire or vice versa?

The chosen exam format should be selected *before* enrolling. IMPORTANT NOTE: Due to the additional administration involved in changing reports, timetables, notices and certificates, changing from one exam format to the other **after** the time of enrolment will incur a **subject change fee** of \$30 per candidate.

Why would I choose the Comprehensive exam format?

Student Advantage: the **Comprehensive** exam format tests a range of musical skills and requires greater preparation. As the more rigorous exam offered by AMEB, the **Comprehensive** exam achievement would be expected when applying for high school music scholarships, university bonus points schemes, entry to orchestras etc.

Teacher Advantage: The more rigorous **Comprehensive** exam will be suitably recognised when calculating the AMEB (NSW) Teaching Awards from 2019 onward.

Why would I choose the Repertoire exam format?

Ideally, teachers would suggest this exam format **prescriptively** for a subset of their students.

The **Repertoire** format provides greater access for students who may not have considered doing a **Comprehensive** exam for one of the following reasons.

Some students:

- play **multiple instruments** and might only want to sit for a **Comprehensive** exam on their first instrument, but appreciate the feedback on subsequent instruments.
- may be new to Australia and arrive musically-proficient, but with developing English skills. They may feel unready to sit for an AMEB exam until their English communication improves
- struggle with **anxiety** or a condition that affects their **speech** or **comprehension**
- may only receive **short lessons** during school terms, thus feel ill-prepared to attempt a **Comprehensive** exam each year
- are in Year 12, spending the bulk of their music lessons working on their **HSC music** exam program. Feedback via a **Repertoire** exam in the First Metro round may be valuable as they prepare for their HSC performance later in the year. It could also be appealing as Level 2 candidates can present up to two HSC pieces (from outside the AMEB syllabus) as part of their **Repertoire** program.

We hope teachers consider the new **Repertoire** examination if it can make examinations a worthwhile and achievable goal for more of your students.